Priscis Libentius et Liberius Novis

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zur historisch-vergleichenden Sprachwissenschaft

Herausgegeben von
Harald Bichlmeier und Velizar Sadovski

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# Priscis Libentius et Liberius Novis

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Festschrift für Gerhard Meiser zum 65. Geburtstag

Herausgegeben von
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unter Mitarbeit von
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# ON THE TREATMENT OF PIE *$g^{H}R$- IN LATIN

Brent Vine, Los Angeles

**1.1.** One of the most notorious problems of Latin historical phonology concerns the development of word-initial *$g^{h}r$- (and *$\hat{g}^{h}r$-), usually considered together with *$g^{h}l$- (and *$\hat{g}^{h}l$-).[1] There are essentially three positions that have been taken:

(a) The regular result of *$g^{h}r$-/*$g^{h}l$- is *gr-*/*gl-*, as in *gradior* 'step',[2] *glaber* 'smooth',[3] *grāmen* 'grass',[4] whereas forms in *r-* reflect a dialectal (probably Sabellic) treatment, as in *rāvus* 'grey, tawny'[5] (cf. other color terms with such a background, most transparently *rūfus* 'red, red-haired') or (neut.) *rūdus* 'gravel, rubble'.[6] This was the view of Sommer (1914: 61),[7] followed by van der Staaij (and de Vaan), Meiser (cf. n. 1), and others.[8]

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[1] I dispense with the palatal notation in what follows, since the PIE velar/palatal distinction was lost in Italic and is therefore irrelevant for the problem. The most extended survey of data and earlier literature is that of Leumann (1977: 166); see more recently Schrijver 1991: 311, Sihler 1995: 158, van der Staaij 1995: 57, Meiser 1998: 103, Stuart-Smith 2004: 152f., Viredaz 2005: 167, *EDLIL* (s. vv. *-gruō*, *rāvus*, following van der Staaij), Weiss 2011: 156, 163, and Zair 2013: 284f. Warm thanks to Michiel de Vaan for making van der Staaij's work available to me.

[2] I. e. according to the traditional reconstruction of a root *$g^{h}red^{h}$-, based on comparison with OCS *grędǫ* 'come, step' and other material in Germanic and Celtic (e. g. *IEW* 456f.); but as de Vaan points out (*EDLIL* s. v. *gradior,* with references), the root in question is now reconstructed as *$g^{h}r(e)id^{h}$-, which introduces severe complications for Lat. *gradior.*

[3] Cf. OCS *gladŭkŭ,* OHG *glat* 'id.'. We need not enter into the analysis of the *ă*-vocalism in Latin and Germanic (vs. the "*ā*-grade" of Balto-Slavic, e. g. < *$g^{h}leh_{2}d^{h}$-), since we are mainly concerned with the root consonantism *$g^{h}l...d^{h}$-. See, however, Schrijver 1991: 188 (on *glaber* and the Germanic forms via zero grade *$g^{h}lh_{2}d^{h}$-) and more generally 184–191 on his rule *CRHTC* > *CRăTC*; *contra*, Neri 2011: 252 via full grades and the "weather rule".

[4] I. e. assuming cognation with Gmc. **grasa-* 'id.' (Schrijver 1991: 487, *EDLIL* s. v., *EDPG* s. v. **grasa-*), rather than Ved. *grásate*, Gk. γράω 'devour' (*DELL* s. v., Watkins 2011: 33). More below on this word in 2.2.

[5] Cf. OHG *grāo,* OIc. *grár,* OE *grǣg* (> Eng. *grey*), etc. < Gmc. **grē-u̯o-* (Transponat *$g^{h}reh_{1}$-*u̯o-*; thus Lat. *rāvus* < zero grade *$g^{h}r̥h_{1}$-*u̯o-*).

[6] Cf. OHG *grioz,* OE *grēot* 'sand, grit', OCS *gruda* 'clod', OPr. *grūdas* 'corn', and other material in Balto-Slavic and Germanic (*IEW* 461). But see below (1.2) for more on Lat. *rūdus.*

(b) The regular result of *$g^hr$-/*$g^hl$- is *r*-/*l*-, via a presumed development Ital. *$\chi r$-/*$\chi l$- > pre-Lat. **hr*-/**hl*- > Lat. *r*-/*l*-, as in *rāvus* for *$g^hr$- and *lūridus* '(purplish-)yellow',[9] *lūtum* 'yellow dye, yellow color'[10] for *$g^hl$-, while forms like *glaber* result from an early Grassmann-like dissimilation of aspiration (Walde 1906), or (at a later stage) a spirant dissimilation. This is the view of Weiss (n. 1), basically following Walde 1906, though without an example for *$g^hl$- > *l*-.[11]

(c) The regular result of *$g^hr$- is *r*- (as in *rāvus*), but the regular result of *$g^hl$- is *gl*- (as in *glaber*). This is the view of Schrijver (n. 1).

**1.2.** Almost all of the relevant evidence has just been presented, and unfortunately, some of the etymologies are disputed (i. e., in addition to *gradior*, already problematized in n. 2, and besides the alternative possibility for *grāmen* involving initial **gr*- cited in n. 4, more on which below).

Thus for *lūridus,* more attractive etyma are now available, based on roots in **l*- (Schrijver 1995: 332) or **(s)l*- (Nussbaum 1997: 199f., 1999: 403f.; see *EDLIL* s. v.), which can also accommodate *lūtum*; *lūridus* and *lūtum* are therefore best eliminated as potential evidence.

For *rūdus* (and its probable inner-Latin cognate *rudis* 'uncultivated, crude' [Pl.+][12]), an alternative theory[13] equates *rūdus* 'rubble' with *rūdus* 'rough piece of metal or stone; bronze coin' (Lucil.+), a variant of a word better attested as *raudus* and also found in the forms *rōdus* and *roudus* (Fest.). According to Risch (1979: 710–712), *raudus* (and its variants) as well as *rudis* are derivatives of PIE *$h_1reud^h$- 'red'; more tentatively, he suggests (1979: 721 n. 31) that *rūdus*

[7] Similarly Sommer/Pfister 1977: 135 ("*χr*-, *χl*- werden *gr*-, *gl*-", but without specifying the background of the *r*-forms).

[8] E. g. Bock 2008: 245, citing Meiser. See also Leumann loc. cit. (n. 1) for variants of this approach according to which the *r*-treatment is not dialectal, but related to a more restricted phonological environment, e. g. words with medial /u̯/ or /u/ (as in *rāvus, rūdus*).

[9] I. e. according to an old etymology (Curtius and others, references at *LEW* s. v.) based on comparison with Gk. χλοερός 'fresh, verdant' and/or χλωρός 'greenish, yellowish'; more on this point below.

[10] I. e. assuming an etymological connection with Lat. *helvus* 'yellow' and ultimately Gk. χλωρός (cf. preceding note); references at *LEW* s. v., Leumann loc. cit. (n. 1). Despite Sommer (1914: 52), favoring an old etymology of Persson comparing Lat. *laetus* 'rich, happy' with NHG *gleißen* 'glitter, glisten' (see *LEW* I.750, s. v. 1. *laetus*, for details), there is no evidence in support of such a connection for *laetus*, the etymology of which remains obscure.

[11] See also Weiss 2011: 156 for other forms that may show such a dissimilation (*barba* 'beard', *trahō* 'drag'). On the regular phonological development *$\chi R$- > **hR*- > *R*-, see Sommer 1914: 52.

[12] Pl. *Poen.* 189; thus not "Varro+" (*EDLIL* s. v.).

[13] See e. g. Leumann 1977: 73 (tentatively); but see later in this paragraph on Leumann's preferred conception.

'rubble' could belong here as well. But in the absence of any coherent account of the unexpected medial *-d-* (beyond a vague appeal to Venetic), Risch's analysis is probably to be rejected.[14] In any case, *raudus* (with its variants) is best kept apart from *rūdus* 'rubble' (and *rudis*); so already Meillet (in *DELL*), and more recently de Vaan (in *EDLIL*). In the footnote just referenced, Risch himself acknowledged Leumann's apparent preference (1977: 166) to align *rūdus* 'rubble' with the *$g^{h}reud$- in Germanic words for 'gravel, grit' (see n. 6 above).

For *rāvus*, the alternative etymology based on comparison with *r*-initial forms[15] is still favored by van der Staaij (1995: 57); but Schrijver's arguments against this approach are persuasive (1991: 298f., 311). Nevertheless, this form introduces a striking and (so far) unique complication, namely evidence for an alternate version of the form with initial *gr-* preserved in the manuscript tradition of Plautus (*Ep.* 620), with support in the grammatical tradition: *ravistellus* A, but *gravastellus* P (i. e. 'old-timer, greybeard', diminutive of a form **(g)rāvāster*).[16]

Other material sometimes adduced is not really usable: thus, despite de Vaan (*EDLIL* s. v. *-gruō*), it is not legitimate to suppose that behind *congruō* 'unite, agree' and *ingruō* 'attack' lies a simplex **gruō* 'rush', with initial *gr-*.[17] Indeed, Sihler has suggested (1995: 158, cf. already Walde 1906: 99) that the simplex is none other than Lat. *ruō* 'rush'. This is not likely to be correct;[18] yet it remains possible in principle that /-gr-/ in *congruō* and *ingruō* reflects a medial treatment, contrasting with an initial treatment /r-/.[19]

Similarly, Lat. *grunda* 'roof' (attested only in glosses), sometimes adduced in this connection (e. g. Walde 1906: 99, Meiser 1986: 74), could well be backformed to *suggrunda* 'ledge, sill' (Varro+), as de Vaan points out (*EDLIL* s. v. *grunda*).

The picture would become hopelessly complicated with the addition of Lat. *frendō* 'grind one's teeth', if this is taken, with *IEW* 459,[20] from a root *$g^{h}rend^{h}$-

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[14] So also *EDLIL* (s. v. *rudis*), on semantic grounds: "there is not a shimmer of a meaning 'red' in *rudis* or in *rūdus* 'rubble'" – which is not quite fair to Risch, who did point (1979: 721 n. 31) to the close association of *rūdectus* 'full of rubble' (referring to soil) with *rubrīcōsus* 'full of red ochre' in two of its attestations in Cato *Ag.* (34.2, 35.1); but this is more likely an episodic collocation, of no value for the etymology.

[15] *IEW* 853: cf. Ved. *rāmá-* 'dark-colored', OHG *rāmac* 'dirty'.

[16] Cf. *gravastellus* P.F. 85.23L (but *ravistellus* P.F. 339.4–5L); further *CGL* II.35.19 *grandellus:* γερων πολυετης, with marginal correction *gravistellus.*

[17] The root is reconstructed as *$g^{h}reh_{1}u$-, according to *LIV* (Pokorny's 1. $g^{h}rēu$-, *IEW* 460).

[18] For arguments against this view, see Sommer 1914: 52 and Bock 2008: 263.

[19] Cf., for example, the medial post-nasal treatment of plain *$ĝ^{h}$ and *$g^{h}$ (> /-ng-/) vs. the initial treatment (> /h-/).

[20] Similarly *LIV* (s. v. *$g^{(w)h}rend$-), with *$g^{h}r$- as an option for the initial cluster.

'zerreiben'. But, as discussed by Bock (2008: 245f.; similarly de Vaan, *EDLIL* s. v.), the Latin form and all relevant comparanda are consistent with *$g^{wh}r$-, which stands as the most attractive assumption for the onset cluster. We can therefore leave this item aside.

**2.1.** Under these difficult circumstances, there can be little certainty about the precise interpretation of this meager haul of data. But there are two new items that may offer a new perspective on the problem.

**2.2.** In a recent study (2016), I attempt to build on a theory of A. Christol (1996: 809–811, cf. Weiss 2011: 151 n. 14) concerning *s*-gemination and non-application of rhotacism. According to this theory, at the time of rhotacism, some forms with medial intervocalic *-*s*- could have remained at the stage with intervocalic [z] (as in Oscan: gen. pl. fem. *egmazum* 'rerum' etc., cf. Lat. -*ārum*). Then, speakers in fully-rhotacizing dialects (or preferring to use a rhotacizing phonostyle) would identify the [z] of /VzV/ forms with [ss], which at that time would have been the only intervocalic sibilant in rhotacizing speech; cf. Lat. ⟨ss⟩ rendering Gk. ζ, phonetically [z] in Hellenistic times.[21] For original /V:zV/ sequences, at first heard as /V:ssV/ by rhotacizing speakers: once the Classical Latin *ss*-simplification had occurred (OLat. *cāssus*, *caussa* > Class. *cāsus*, *causa*, etc.) – i. e., with /V:ssV/ no longer a permitted sequence[22] – some such unrhotacized forms could have entered the speech of rhotacizing speakers in the form /VssV/. This kind of borrowing could have occurred, for example, with unrhotacized forms belonging to a rural dialect or a particular speech register, especially in situations where a high-style alternative did not exist.
In particular, I suggested that one such word was Lat. *grossus* 'unripe fig' (Cato+), also (as an adjective) 'green, unripe, immature (of fruit)' (Col.+); and the adjective (despite the date of its attestation) could have been the earlier sense, with 'unripe fig' a substantivization. This word, hitherto without etymology, is ordinarily conflated with *grossus* 'thick, fat, coarse', which nevertheless is best kept apart (so properly *DELL*, with two separate entries). In my view, the agricultural term *grossus* – a prime candidate for borrowing from a rustic dialect into the standard language – can be attractively interpreted etymologically as based on the root of Eng. *grow* (OE *grōwan*, OIc. *gróa*, etc. < *$g^{h}roh_1$-*i̯e*/*o*-) and *green* (OS *grōni*, OHG *gruoni*, etc. < *$g^{h}roh_1$-*ni*-), and specifically an *s*-extended version of that root, possibly to be compared with Lat. *grāmen* 'grass'

[21] On Gk. medial -ζ- ~ Lat. ⟨-ss-⟩, see Biville 1990: 108–110, including Gk. -τζω ~ Lat. -*issō* (112–114).

[22] With restricted exceptions, such as verbal forms of the type *audīsse* (< *audīvisse*) and (analogically) *amāsse*, etc. (Leumann 1977: 181).

(Cato+), in theory from pre-Lat. **grasmen* or **grā(s)men*. Germanic comparanda pointing to Pr.-Gmc. **grōsō-*[23] and (with analogical onset in the zero-grade form) **grasa-*[24] favor pre-Lat. **grā(s)men* < **$g^{h}_{\circ}rh_{1}$-(s)-mn̥* for Lat. *grāmen*[25] and point to an *o*-grade basis **$g^{h}roh_{1}$-s-o-* > pre-Lat. **grōso-* for Lat. *grossus* (with non-rhotacism and *s*-gemination according to Christol's theory). This analysis, then, adds a new item for the **$g^{h}r$-* > Lat. *gr-* dossier, and offers some support for the idea that Lat. *grāmen* belongs there as well. Note further that both terms are patently 'rustic' in terms of their semantic reference, and *grossus* in particular (according to the theory that accounts for its geminate ⟨-ss-⟩) would reflect an instance of dialect-borrowing (plausibly from some non-urban speech form or sub-elite register). In contrast, recalling one of the traditional claims about the initial *r-* of Lat. *rāvus* as a Sabellicism (1.1.(a) above): there is in fact nothing formally (or, for that matter, semantically) specific to *rāvus* that points to Sabellic or any other dialectal or non-standard origin (in contrast, for example, with the medial *-f-* of *rūfus*, a clear Sabellic feature).

**2.3.** Another such item can be added, based on recent analyses by Zair (2012: 100 and, in much more detail, 2013), namely Lat. *glārea* 'gravel' (Cato+). As Zair shows, the word's closest relative (hitherto unrecognized) appears in the Pr.-Celt. **grāu̯ā* that underlies Middle and Modern Welsh *gro* 'gravel, shingle', Old Cornish *grou* and Middle Cornish *grow* 'sand, gravel', and the possible Gaulish source of French *grève* 'sandy beach' (but see further below on this form). Thus the Latin word goes back to an original **grāro-* or **grārā*, with liquid dissimilation and derivation via the 'material suffix' **-ei̯o-*. Moreover, evidence from modern Italian dialects (e. g. Friulian *grava* 'gravel') may point to a parallel Latin source form **grāva* < pre-Lat. **grāu̯ā*, identical to the Pr.-Celt. **grāu̯ā* of W. *gro* etc.[26] Finally, since the Latin and Celtic material displays an impeccably Indo-European suffix alternation (**grā-ro-* ~ **grā-u̯ā*), it is legitimate to seek an Indo-European etymology. Zair considers various possibilities (2013: 282–285); the details are complex and need not be recapitulated here in full. What is most important for present purposes is that Zair argues persuasively in favor of association with a root PIE **$g^{h}reh_{1}$(u̯)-*, ultimately the same as the **$g^{h}reh_{1}u̯$-* that may be set up for Pokorny's "2. *$g^{h}rēu$-*" 'scharf darüber reiben, zerreiben' (*IEW* 460f.) – the source, in fact, of enlarged forms in

[23] MHG *gruose* 'sprout; sap', MLG *grōse* 'sap'.

[24] Go./OHG/OIc. *gras*, OE *græs* 'grass'.

[25] So also Schrijver 1991: 487, *EDLIL* s. v., *EDP-G* s. v. **grasa-*.

[26] If so, as Zair points out (2013: 281 n. 5), this Latin (i. e. probably 'Vulgar Latin') form could be the source of Fr. *grève*, rather than a Gaulish cognate of W. *gro* etc.

Germanic and Balto-Slavic with similar meaning (*IEW* 461), including *$*g^hreh_1u$-d-* (*IEW* "*$*g^hreud$-") in the Germanic words for 'gravel, stone, grit' (OHG *grioz* etc.) already compared above (1.1(a) with n. 6) with Lat. *rūdus* 'gravel, rubble'. Zair's primary reservation about this connection for Lat. *glārea* and the Celtic material involves, to be sure, the very question at issue here, i. e. the controversial Latin outcome of PIE *$*g^hR$-. But what is an indeterminacy for Zair is for us simply a feature of his attractive etymological analysis, with the result that Lat. *glārea* (and the pre-Latin *$*grāu̯ā$* underlying the Italian dialectal forms) can be taken as an additional example of PIE *$*g^hr$- > Lat. *gr-*.
As a further result, we now have two words with the same basic meaning ('gravel' vel sim.), and ultimately (according to the analyses favored here) based on the same root, which have ended up with different treatments, i. e. *rūdus* (*$*g^hr$- > *r-*) vs. *glārea* (*$*g^hr$- > **gr-*, before the dissimilation). Recall that we have already seen this behavior, with *rāvus* and *rāvistellus* vs. *grāvāstellus* (1.2). It is perfectly reasonable, then, to expect another such pair to surface, although it remains to provide a possible explanation for this sort of variation.

**2.4.** An item similar to Lat. *grossus* and *glārea*/**grāva* could perhaps be added for the treatment of *$*g^hl$-*, although the case is ambiguous and uncertain in some respects. Lat. *glēba* 'clod, lump of earth' (Cato+), which probably belongs with Lat. *globus* 'round compact mass' (Pl.+), is traditionally[27] compared with material in Germanic and Baltic. Addressing the Germanic data, de Vaan (*EDLIL* s. v. *glēba*) comments: "The Gm. forms which are often compared […] do not mean 'round', and are better ignored." De Vaan, however, cites only OHG *klāftra* (NHG *Klafter*) 'measure of extended arms'. But this is not quite legitimate: some North Germanic material pointing to **glēb-* is also cited, and it could be argued that, for example, ON *kláp-eygr* 'saucer-eyed, goggle-eyed' does indeed correlate with 'roundness' in a fairly clear way. Nevertheless, the North Germanic material is considerably more varied, and does not in fact lend itself easily to such a facile interpretation. Thus simplex ON *klápr* is a nickname or term of abuse, the literal meaning of which is not really known; and modern descendants have a bewildering variety of meanings not readily associated with roundness, e. g. Mod.Ic. *klápur* '(milk) container; bulky or unskillfully made object; annoying or foul-mouthed person'.[28] To complicate matters (both formally and semantically), the word is said to be closely related to ON *kláfr*/ Mod.Ic. *kláfur*, a square or rectangular box for transport or storage.[29] It may

[27] E. g. *LEW* I.606, *IEW* 359f., *AEW* 298 (s. v. *kalfr*).
[28] See e. g. *ÍO* 471 s. v.

well be advisable, then, at least provisionally, to separate the Germanic material, in which case we are left with the Baltic forms (such as Lith. *glėbti* 'embrace'). These could then in principle, together with the Latin forms, point to a root *$g^{h}leb^{(h)}$- (rather than the *$gleb^{(h)}$- usually assumed). If so, this evidently 'rustic' material[30] could provide an example of the development *$g^{h}l$- > Lat. *gl*-. Note, however, that if the final consonant of the root is a voiced aspirated *-$b^{h}$-, we might instead have another example of the *glaber* type (cf. 1.1).[31] There is, finally for *glēba*, the problematic spelling *glaeba*,[32] as in a number of other words in which this alternation poses interpretive difficulties (Leumann 1977: 68).
Further uncertainty is introduced by Lat. *glomus* (neut.) 'ball (of yarn, thread, etc.)' (Varro+), sometimes thought to belong with *glēba* and *globus* (so e. g. *LEW* s. v. *glomus*). Formally, however, the connection is difficult, since a pre-Lat. **glob-mo-* or **glob-m-es-*[33] should have led to †*glommus*, with gemination, as already pointed out in *LEW*, which, following Persson, operates with a version of enlargement theory that is no longer tenable (i. e. **gel-* 'ballen' → **gle-b$^{(h)}$-* and **gle-m-*). But even if we update the hyphens (i. e. **gl-eb$^{(h)}$-* and **gl-em-*) or, as in *IEW*, non-committally remove them altogether,[34] it remains thinkable that the Lat. *glēb-*/*glob-* ~ *glom-*/*glem-* variation continues substrate material without a real Indo-European basis (see discussion along these lines in *EDLIL* s. v. *glomus* and *EDBIL* s. v. *glėbti*).

**3.1.** The above considerations – especially concerning the addition to the dossier of *grossus* and *glārea* – suggest the following more nuanced alternative to the proposals listed at the outset:

(a.1) the regular result of *$g^{h}r$- is *r*- (as in *rāvus* and *rūdus*)
(a.2) the regular result of *$g^{h}l$- is probably *l*-, but there are no clear examples (since *lūridus* and *lūtum* should be excluded)

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[29] See *ÍO* 470 s. v. *kláfur*, with comparison to Lat. *glēba*, *globus* and the Baltic material. (Thanks to Aurelijus Vijūnas for valuable assistance with the North Germanic forms.)

[30] Note also the derived form *glēbō* 'arator, rusticus' (frequent in *CGL*, see *CGL* VI, p. 495 s. v.). There is no basis for the assumption (*IEW* 359) that this form is Gaulish or influenced by Gaulish.

[31] Schrijver (1991: 125) prefers to assume root-final *-*b*-, with lengthening of the root vowel in Baltic by Winter's Law. But the situation is not in fact so clear; see *EDBIL* 181 (s. v. *glėbti*) on evidence for circumflex intonation and possible indeterminacies surrounding the final consonant. If, moreover, the *glefa* surviving in Calabrian dialects (*REW* 323, no. 3782) is to be interpreted as a genuine Sabellicism (see Adams 2007: 433, with references), this would point to *-$b^{h}$-.

[32] Well-attested in the manuscripts of Pliny, but also found elsewhere; details in *TLL* s. v. *glēba*, following Georges 1890: 302f. (s. v. *gleba*).

[33] Or **gleb-m-*, cf. Romance evidence for **glemo-* (see *DELL* s. v. *glomus*).

[34] *IEW* **gleb$^{(h)}$-* (359) and **glem-* (360), as enlarged forms of 1. *gel-* 'ballen, sich ballen; Gerundetes, Kugeliges' (357).

(b.1) the 'rustic' (or low-register, etc.) result of *$g^hr$- is *gr*- (as in *grossus*, *grāmen*, **grārea* > *glārea*, and perhaps the *grāvāstellus* preserved at Pl. *Ep.* 620 and in the grammatical tradition)

(b.2) the 'rustic' (or low-register, etc.) result of *$g^hl$- is probably *gl*- (as perhaps in *glēba* and *globus*, but see c.2 below)

(c.1) the regular result of *$g^hr$-...$D^h$ is probably *gr*-, via aspirate or spirant dissimilation, as possibly in *gradior*; but the nature of its root remains unclear, and other examples are lacking

(c.2) the regular result of *$g^hl$-...$D^h$ is *gl*- (as in *glaber*), via aspirate or spirant dissimilation (which might also be exemplified by *glēba* and *globus*, depending on one's assumptions about the root-final consonant)

**3.2.** It remains to comment, first of all, on the variation seen in the (a.1) vs. (b.1) pairs *rāvus*/*grāvāstellus* and *rūdus*/**grārea* (> *glārea*), in connection with the proposed identification of the /gr-/ forms as belonging to 'rustic' speech, via comparison (in the first instance) with *grossus* and *grāmen.*

For *grāvāstellus*, there is little that can be said with certainty, although the basic facts may be suggestive. In the passage in question (Pl. *Ep.* 620), the titular character Epidicus, a typical Plautine *servus callidus*, spies the Moneylender approaching, together with a woman:

*sed quis haec est muliercula et ille gravastellus qui venit?*[35]

Despite the question format, he may well recognize the Moneylender (generally an unsavory figure in Plautine comedy), whom he dreads. Epidicus at this point is highly upset because he anticipates disaster, and naturally uses a disparaging tone, indicated here first of all by the diminutives in both *muliercula* and *gravastellus*, reinforced in the latter by the suffixation itself.[36] In this context, then, *gravastellus* could well be at least a mildly abusive term (perhaps something like Eng. *geezer*), for which a subliterary or low-register variant of some sort (including a 'rustic' one) would be appropriate. This would contrast with the basic color-term *rāvus*, which belongs to the standard language.

As for *rūdus* vs. *glārea:* note first that, as already mentioned (1.2), *rūdus* is widely assumed to be related to the adjective *rudis* 'uncultivated, crude'. That word is perfectly at home in high-style literature, including poetry: attested, for example, in Virgil, Horace, Lucan, and Manilius, it is particularly frequent in

[35] *gravastellus* (P, vs. *ravistellus* A; cf. 1.2 above) is printed by Lindsay, Leo, and Ernout. Differently de Melo (2011), who prints *ravastellus.*

[36] See Leumann (1977: 318f.) on the negative semantic value of *-āstro-* formations ("ein kümmerlicher, minderwertiger […]").

Propertius and Ovid. *Rūdus*, to be sure, is not a 'poetic word',[37] but given its meaning, this is hardly to be expected. Although the word can indeed occasionally mean 'gravel' "as occurring in nature" (*OLD* **1b**; Varro, Columella),[38] its primary sense is rather 'rubble', i. e. "resulting from the decay of buildings, excavations, or sim." (*OLD* **1a**; Tacitus, Suetonius, etc.) or "used in laying pavements; also as a roofing material" (*OLD* **2**; Vitruvius, Pliny, *Bellum Alex.*, *Bellum Hispan.*). In contrast, *glārea* essentially refers to 'gravel', as found in rocky soil: cf. the *TLL* definition "genus quoddam harenae crassioris ex minutis lapillis constantis, qualis invenitur et in ripis aquarum et in sterilibus terrae locis", subsuming by far the lion's share of attestations; and the same specialization is even more pronounced with the derived adjective *glāreōsus*, where all of the attestations are of this type (see *TLL* s. v.: *glareosis arvis*, *loca glareosa*, *glareosum solum*, *glareosa terra*, etc.). While *glārea* can be used "ad pavimentum sternendum" (Cato and Columella, thus actually in an agricultural context) and even "ad vias sternendas" (Cic.+), it seems significant that gravel roads, as such, were essentially a non-urban feature, as Livy notes expressly (41.27.5): *censores vias sternendas silice in urbe, glarea extra urbem substruendas marginandasque primi omnium locaverunt.*[39] Thus *rūdus* (perhaps related to *rudis*,[40] a word freely occurring in elevated language), while clearly a "technical" term (as in the engineering vocabulary of road-building), was primarily not a "rustic" one, whereas *glārea* and *glāreōsus* were most at home precisely in agricultural and topographic contexts. Note finally, in this context, Zair's observation (2013: 280) that the liquid dissimilation in *glārea* may be a mark of the word's subliterary status, a feature otherwise clear in any case for the word's close relative Vulgar Latin **grāva* underlying Italian dialectal forms (and possibly Fr. *grève*).

**3.3.** The presumed phonetic development for pattern 3.1(a) has already been mentioned (in 1.1(b): Ital. **χr-/*χl-* > pre-Lat. **hr-/*hl-* > Lat. *r-/l-*) and is easily supported by typological parallels, as in Germanic: thus the same development applied to the outcome of PIE **kr-/*kl-* in English (> Gmc. **χr-/*χl-* > OE **hr-/*hl-* > Eng. *r-/l-*). For pattern 3.1(b), the most natural assumption would

[37] Its only attestation in poetry occurs in Lucilius (408 Marx).

[38] Cf. also the derived adjective *rūdectus* in Cato *Ag.* (n. 14 above): *terra* […] *rudecta* (34.2), *in rudecto* […] *loco* (35.1), *loca* […] *rudecta* (131).

[39] On this passage see Quilici 2008: 563, and further 567f. on gravel roads.

[40] The derivational morphology is unrecoverable, but there are plausible possibilities. For example, PIE **$g^{h}reh_{1}$-u-d-* could have led to a thematic verb **$g^{h}reud$-e/o-* 'break into pieces' in Italic, comparable to MHG *ver-*, *durch-griezen* (OHG ptcples. *fergrozzeniu*, *gigrozzan*; Seebold 1970: 242), whence parallel verbal nouns **$g^{h}reud$-es-* 'break-up' (concretized as 'rubble') and **$g^{h}rud$-i-* (the latter secondarily adjectivized; see on this process, with additional examples, Nussbaum 2014: 305).

be a secondary voicing either of Ital. **χr-/*χl-* or of "post-Ital." **hr-/*hl-* to **γr-/*γl-*, whence occlusion to *gr-/gl-*. The second step (**γr-/*γl-* > *gr-/gl-*) again finds parallels in Germanic – very broadly, if one accepts the traditional assumption of a velar spirant (even in initial position) for the Proto-Gmc. Outcome of PIE **ĝʰ/*gʰ* (Moulton 1954: 42); note also the occlusion of OIc. Medial **-γl-* in Icelandic and Faroese.[41] A further parallel showing an overall development **χr-* > *gr-* is found in Khotanese Saka (there also **fr-* > *br-*, **θr-* > *dr-*): thus *gratä* 'instruction, advice' < **xratu-* (cf. Av. *xratu-*, OP *xraθu-*; Bailey 1979: 91 s. v.), *grūs-* 'to call' < **xrausa-* (cf. Av. *xraos-*; Bailey 1979: 93 s. v.); and similar developments are also found in Pashto.[42] And if, instead of beginning with Ital. **χR-*, one adopts the alternative conception of the development of the *mediae aspiratae* in Italic – i. e. **gʰR-* > voiced **γR-* in the first instance – one can operate with a single-step occlusion to *gR-*.[43]
The Grassmann-like dissimilation in pattern 3.1(c) has its own typological support, which hardly requires further comment, and which I have addressed elsewhere (2014, with references).

**3.4.** Note finally that the somewhat crude cover term "rustic" (as used above) is not necessarily equivalent to "Sabellic": Adams (2007) has treated a number of regional features of Latin similar to those found in Sabellic, but perhaps "native" to some varieties of dialectal Latin.[44] He has shown, moreover, that the evaluation of so-called *sermo rusticus* is a highly complex matter, sometimes even involving speech behavior that was positively valued by ancient commentators, rather than treated neutrally as the source of various types of linguistic variation, or (as especially with the term *agrestis*) relegated to a lower register, as compared with urban Latin.[45] In principle, the "rustic" element in question here can be related to factors other than speech register or regionalism, for example occupational vocabulary, i. e. what one might call "farmers' argot". There are many ancient testimonia on lexical items that belong to the special vocabulary of agriculture,[46] or rural usages connected with otherwise

[41] Thanks to Aurelijus Vijūnas for discussion of the Icelandic and Faroese data.

[42] Thus for **θr-* > *dr-*, e. g. *dre* (dial. *drey*, *dray*) 'three' (cf. Av. *θrāiiō*, Khot. *drai*); Morgenstierne 2003: 22 s. v. (The Iranian parallels were kindly pointed out to me by Martin Kümmel.)

[43] See the discussion by Meiser (1998: 101), adducing **gʰR-* > *gR-* as a possible argument in favor of the alternative conception.

[44] E. g. Adams 2007: 108–110 on /ai/ to /ē/ monophthongizations, often assumed to be related to an Umbrian substrate.

[45] On the complexity of "rustic" Latin, including positive valuations, see e. g. Adams 2007: 19f., 136f., 145f. For general orientation see also Clackson 2011: 514–519 on "class-based variation", including rural vs. urban speech forms.

standard vocabulary,[47] or even morphological material, such as *-aria* in terms referring to the place where an edible plant is grown.[48] Most familiar, perhaps, are various phonological features (treated extensively by Adams 2007 *passim*), such as the monophthongization already referred to (n. 44), among others. There is, to be sure, plenty of room for skepticism about the distinction suggested above concerning "rustic" *gR*- as opposed to "standard" *R*- in forms derived from PIE *$g^{h}R$-, especially in view of the absence of explicit ancient testimonia on the point. But this may be less of a concern if the developments described above are viewed (as here) as essentially prehistoric, rather than a matter of synchronic variation, except in the rare cases where parallel forms may have survived, as perhaps with *rāvus* ~ *grāvāster* (NB: not actually **grāvus* itself) and *rūdus* ~ *glārea*/**grāva* (with both morphological and semantic differentiation obscuring the underlying etymological connection).[49]

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[46] E. g. *porca* 'ridge of soil between two furrows', also a unit of land measurement (Adams 2007: 216f., 234f.), or botanical terms like *sarralia* 'type of wild lettuce' (Adams 2007: 239f.).

[47] E. g. *natio* 'birth; offspring' in rural speech (Adams 2007: 107), or *pullus* in the technical sense 'friable soil' (2007: 206f.).

[48] See Adams 2007: 314 on *favaria* 'bean-patch', *pisaria* 'pea-patch', *lenticlaria* 'lentil-patch'.

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